

MADE FOR SHARING

Chocolate Cookies

with Peanut Butter Filling

With holiday parties and cookie swaps in full swing, we're breaking out our favorite special-occasion cookies. Food52 recipe developer and food writer Emma Laperruque's family recipe is so much fun to make with others, from mixing to rolling and flattening the dough. Emma's tip: If you decide to re-make these, feel free to swap in your favorite nut butter for a personal twist.

45–55 minutes 4 servings 480 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 4 packets unsalted butter
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar
- 4 packets peanut butter, divided
- 2 tablespoons light brown sugar
- ¼ cup granulated sugar, divided
- ¼ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ⅔ cup flour
- 2 tablespoons cocoa powder
- ¼ teaspoon baking soda
- 1 parchment paper

You'll need

- 1 egg
- kosher salt
- baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

If needed, place packets of peanut butter between your palms for 1–2 minutes. The heat from your hands will help them soften. This is a great task for a kitchen helper.

There's no need to be precise with the shape of the mounds—they'll be wrapped in chocolate cookie dough in Step 4.

The longer the filling sits at room temperature, the more it will soften. Work quickly to ensure the filling is easier to handle.

If there's any leftover filling on the baking sheet, no worries—the parchment doesn't have to be completely clean before baking.

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1. Make peanut butter filling

Preheat oven to 350°F. Unwrap **butter packets** and set aside to soften at room temperature until Step 3. Line a baking sheet with **parchment paper** for the next step. In a large bowl, combine **powdered sugar** and **3 packets peanut butter** (see recipe tip). Stir vigorously until fully combined.



2. Form peanut butter filling

Working 1 at a time, scoop heaping teaspoons of **peanut butter filling** directly onto prepared sheet to create 10 small mounds (see recipe tip). Transfer sheet with filling to freezer to harden slightly, about 15 minutes. Meanwhile, rinse bowl and wipe clean for the next step.



3. Make cookie dough

To bowl from filling, add **light brown sugar**, **softened butter**, **2 tablespoons granulated sugar** (save remainder for Step 5), and **remaining peanut butter**. Stir vigorously until light and fluffy. Add **vanilla** and **1 egg**; stir until fully combined. In a medium bowl, stir together **flour**, **cocoa powder**, **baking soda**, and **½ teaspoon salt**. Add **dry ingredients** to bowl with **peanut butter–egg mixture**; stir to fully incorporate.



4. Form cookies

Once filling is hardened slightly, remove sheet from freezer. Working quickly, scoop tablespoon-size balls of **dough** directly onto sheet with filling to yield 10 dough balls. Using your hands, flatten **dough balls** into thin patties, about 2½ inches wide. Working 1 at a time, add **1 piece filling** to each **dough patty** (see recipe tip). Wrap **dough** around **peanut butter filling** to cover, gently pinching and rolling to seal.



5. Finish and bake cookies

Place **remaining granulated sugar** in a small bowl, then add **cookie dough balls** and gently roll to coat (this is a great task for a kitchen helper). Return **dough balls** to prepared sheet, spacing apart as much as possible (see recipe tip). Using your hands, gently press each **dough ball** to flatten until about ¼-inch thick. Bake until puffed and light brown, 8–9 minutes.



6. Plate chocolate cookies

Once baked, let **chocolate cookies with peanut butter filling** cool for 10 minutes on baking sheet. Use any downtime to get a head start on dishes, or enjoy the sweet smells filling up your kitchen. Then, serve **cookies** while they're still warm—glass of cold milk optional.

Recipe adapted from Food52.

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